

THE BRAND STORYTELLER

► PREETA SUKHTANKAR, 43



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THE ADOPTION OF D2C BRANDS, THEIR STORIES BEING BUILT ON SOCIAL MEDIA, AND THEIR DYNAMIC FOUNDERS COMPRISE A COCKTAIL SUKHTANKAR PLANS TO TAP INTO

► **THIS JANUARY**, when Goat Brand Labs bought a 90 per cent stake in The Label Life, it absorbed most of the start-up's team. Preeta Sukhtankar, Founder, The Label

Life, is now moving to an advisory role. Sukhtankar says the journey has been like training to be a pilot while flying a plane live—scary but thrilling. She set off to build

The Label Life—an online fashion store for women—almost a decade ago along with three separate labels, and is now onto her next. “The Label Life was a brand story from the very beginning and, in my opinion, that story was complete. Hence, selling to someone who would scale and build the ‘business’ of the brand was the right path ahead. As an entrepreneur I’m always itching to do more and I know it sounds like you’ve heard it before, but it is true that if you love what you do, it’s never work and, hence, why rest?”

So what’s next? Sukhtankar finds the Indian consumer story fascinating and with tremendous potential. The adoption of D2C brands, their stories being built on social media, and their dynamic founders comprise a heady cocktail that she is looking to tap into for her new venture. While she is coy about sharing the details, she says she is looking to collaborate with these brands’ stories and help put together a platform that allows these brands to win. Like Ghai, Sukhtankar is also looking at commerce and a more curated target audience. While listing a start-up would definitely be on the bucket list, she doesn’t see that as an end goal. For her, it’s about being able to personally impact, directly or indirectly, as many female-led businesses as possible.

“The term angel investing is now overused, so let me use mentor because we underutilise that one in this country—every founder should have one and not just female.” And she is looking to apply that as she builds out her new business venture and works with brands alongside.